

Answering Greetings and Introducing Yourself with 'To Be'

English Lab · Session 2 · Pre-A1 English for
Adults



Recap: Greetings and Goodbyes

- Informal greetings like **“Hi!”** and **“How are you doing?”** connect you with friends and peers.
- Formal greetings such as **“Good morning”** and **“Nice to meet you”** fit workplaces, interviews, and clients.
- Closing a conversation requires choosing between quick casual signs (**“See you!”**) and polite farewells (**“Have a good day.”**).

Question: When you enter a formal job interview at 9:00 AM, what greeting do you offer?



Learning Objectives

1

Objectives: Respond appropriately to common daily greetings using positive and neutral expressions.

2

Objectives: Match subject pronouns with the correct affirmative forms of *to be* (am, is, are) and short forms.

3

Objectives: Introduce your identity, hometown origin, and current feeling in spoken and written English.



Key Vocabulary



Am

Form of 'to be' used exclusively with the pronoun 'I' (*yo soy / estoy*).



Is

Singular form of 'to be' used for third-person subjects: 'he', 'she', or 'it' (*él/ella es*).



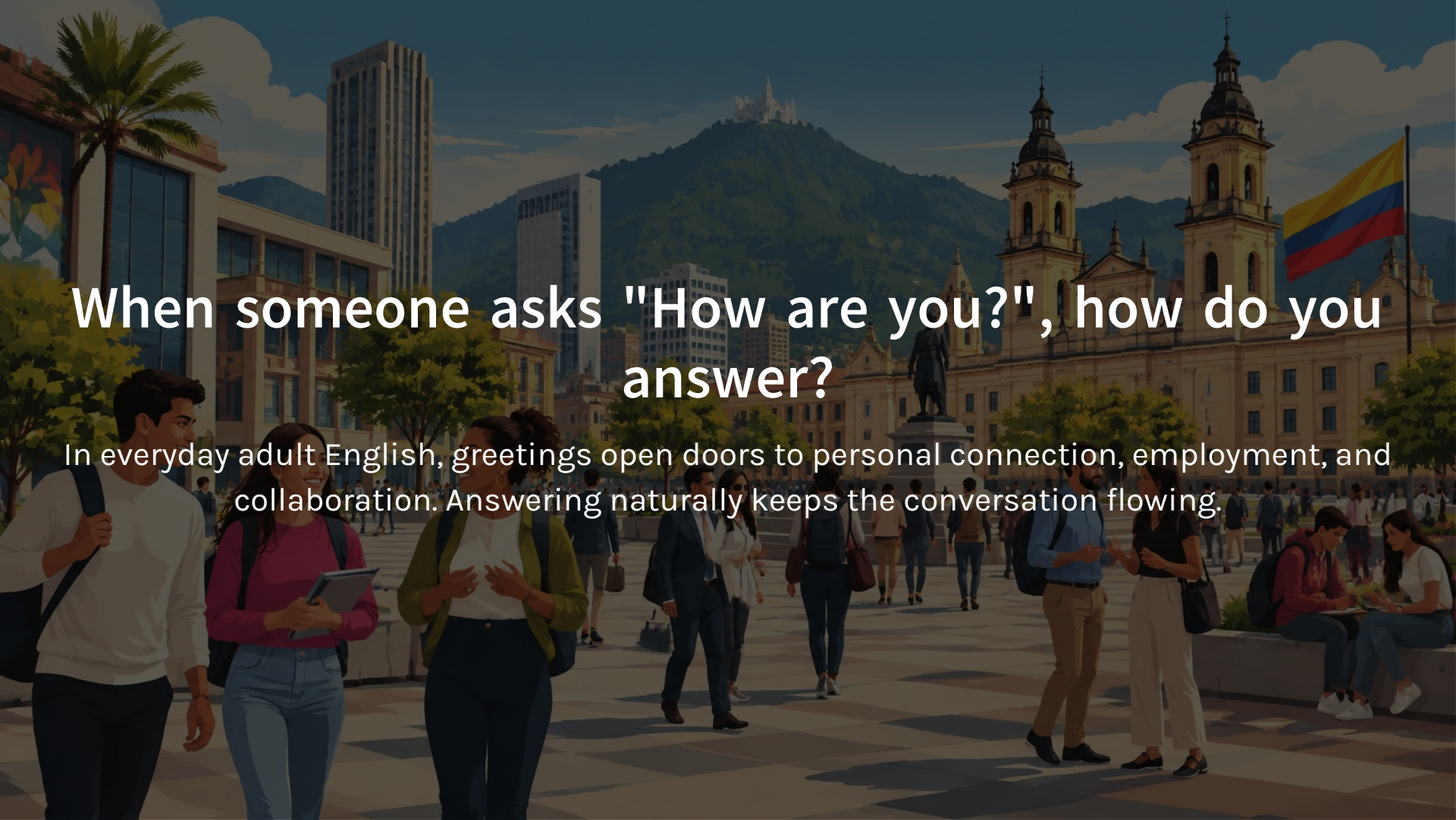
Are

Form of 'to be' used with 'you', 'we', and 'they' (*tú eres, nosotros somos, ellos son*).



From

Preposition showing your origin, home city, or native country (*de / procedente de*).



When someone asks "How are you?", how do you answer?

In everyday adult English, greetings open doors to personal connection, employment, and collaboration. Answering naturally keeps the conversation flowing.

Common Answers to Daily Greetings



Positive

“I'm great!” or “I'm good, thanks!”

Use when you feel energetic and enthusiastic.



Neutral

“I'm fine, thank you.” or “Not bad.”

Polite, classic, and standard in workplaces.



Casual / Honest

“I'm okay.” or “A little tired.”

Acceptable with close friends or classmates.

Polite Greeting Return

Always thank the speaker and
bounce the question back.



Step 1: Answer your state

"I'm fine" or "I'm very good."

Step 2: Express gratitude

"Thank you." (formal) or *"Thanks!"* (informal)

Step 3: Return the inquiry

"And you?" or "How about you?"

Choose the Best Greeting Response

You arrive at a job interview and the director says: 'Good morning! How are you today?'
What is the most appropriate response?

1. What's up? Not much!
2. See you later, bye!
3. I am Sofia from Bogotá.
4. Good morning! I'm fine, thank you. And you?

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Understanding 'To Be' in Context

CORE GRAMMAR

In English, **to be** serves the roles of both Spanish verbs: **ser** and **estar**.

We use it to express four essential categories of basic personal information:

- **Identity (Who):** *I am Carolina.*
- **Origin & Place (Where):** *I am from Colombia.*
- **Role & Profession (What):** *I am a student.*
- **Condition & Emotion (How):** *I am happy.*



The Four Uses of 'To Be'



1. Identity (Who)

State your name and identity.

"I am Carlos." / "She is Ana."



2. Origin (Where)

Indicate where you come from.

"I am from Medellín."



3. Profession (What)

Describe your job or occupation.

"He is an engineer."



4. Feelings (How)

Describe emotional condition.

"We are excited!"

Pronouns and 'To Be' Forms

English verbs change depending on the subject pronoun. Master the three forms: **am**, **is**, and **are**.



I	am	I'm
You	are	You're
He	is	He's
She	is	She's
It	is	It's
We	are	We're
They	are	They're



Full Forms vs. Short Contractions



Singular Subjects

I am → *I'm*

You are → *You're*

He is → *He's*

She is → *She's*

It is → *It's*



Plural Subjects

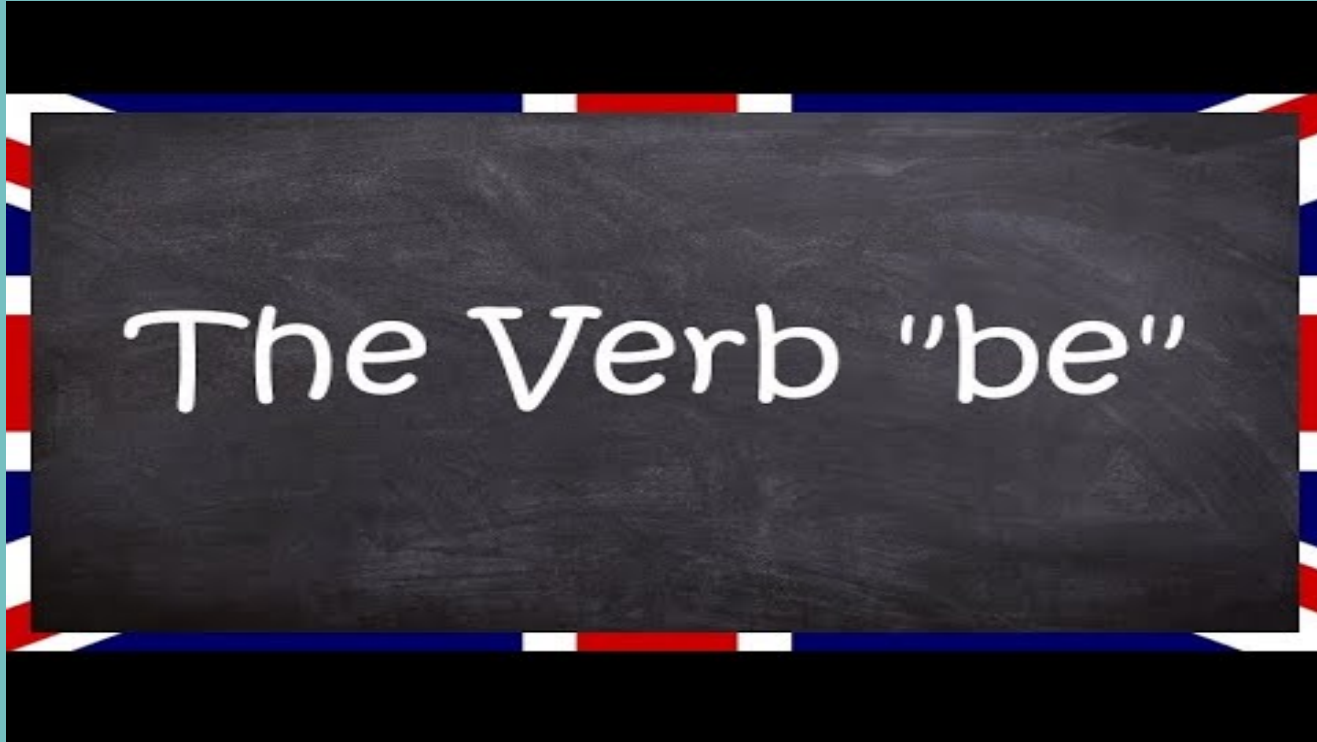
We are → *We're*

They are → *They're*

You are (plural) → *You're*

Contractions are standard in natural spoken English.

Video: Mastering 'To Be' for Introductions



Memory Rule for 'To Be'

A simple rule helps you choose the exact verb form without hesitation:

AM belongs only to **I**.

IS belongs to the three singulars: **He, She, It**.

ARE belongs to **You, We, They**.



Remember

'You' always takes 'are', even when speaking to one person.



Match Pronouns to Verb Forms

Match the words with the definitions

He / She / It

Matches with 'am' (I am)

I

Matches with 'is' (He is / She is)

You

Matches with 'are' (We are / They are)

We / They

Always takes 'are' (You are)

Match Pronouns to Verb Forms

Match the words with the definitions



He / She / It

A

Matches with 'am' (I am)

I

B

Matches with 'is' (He is / She is)

You

C

Matches with 'are' (We are / They are)

We / They

D

Always takes 'are' (You are)



Stating Origin: Using "From"

When stating your home town or country, combine **to be** with the preposition **from**.

Structure: **Subject + to be + from + City / Country**

- *"I am from Colombia." | "I'm from Cali."*
- *"Sofia is from Medellín." | "They are from Barranquilla."*

Word Banks: Cities and Feelings



Colombian Cities

Bogotá · Medellín · Cali ·
Barranquilla · Cartagena ·
Bucaramanga

"I am from Cartagena."



Feelings Bank

Happy · Excited · Calm · Ready · Tired
· Hungry

"I am very happy today."



Watch Out!

In Spanish you say *"Tengo hambre / sueño"* (tener). In English, use **to be**: *"I am hungry", "I am tired"*.



Natural Flow

Combine all three: *"Hello! I am Juan. I am from Cali, and I am excited to be here."*

Model Introduction: Sofia



“Hi! My name is Sofia.

I am 20 years old.

I am from Colombia.

I am a student.

My parents **are** teachers.

We **are** a happy family.

Today, I **am** very excited!”

Listening: Introducing Yourself

Listen to the audio and answer the questions



A Polite Greeting and Introduction

Play audio

- 1 How is Alex feeling today?
- 2 Where is Alex originally from?
- 3 Where does Alex live now?
- 4 What does Carolina say about the team?

Listening: Introducing Yourself

Check your answers below



A Polite Greeting and Introduction

 Play audio

1

He is doing great.

2

He is from Medellín.

3

He lives in Bogotá.

4

They are glad he is here.

Analysing Errors: Sofia's Draft

Incorrect draft:

"Hi! I are a student. My mom are a teacher. My dad are an engineer. We is happy. I are excited!"

Corrected version:

*"Hi! I **am** a student. My mom **is** a teacher. My dad **is** an engineer. We **are** happy. I **am** excited!"*



Mistake to avoid

Do not use 'are' with 'I' or singular nouns like 'mom' and 'dad'.

Singular family members (my mom = she, my dad = he) always require **is**.

Complete with Am, Is, or Are

I _____ from Cali, Carlos _____ my friend, and we _____ happy students.

Word bank 

from

be

are

is

am

Complete with Am, Is, or Are



I **am** from Cali, Carlos **is** my friend, and we **are** happy students.

Word bank 

from

be

are

is

am

Guided Speaking: Your Introduction

Use the template below to build your personal introductory statement:

1. Greeting: *"Good evening!" | "Hello!"*

2. Identity: *"I am [your name]."*

3. Origin: *"I am from [your city]."*

4. Condition: *"I am [feeling] today."*



Conversation Practice in Pairs



Partner A

Greets and asks:

"Hello! How are you doing?"

Follows up:

"Where are you from?"



Partner B

Responds:

"I'm doing great, thank you! And you?"

Shares origin:

"I am from Medellín. And you?"

Self-Assessment: 'I Can...' Check

Evaluate your progress in today's session:

✓ **I can** answer daily greetings with positive or polite expressions.

✓ **I can** match pronouns to 'am', 'is', and 'are' accurately.

✓ **I can** state my name, home city, and current feeling using *to be*.



Check Your Understanding



Question 1:

Which form of 'to be' completes: 'She _____ from Barranquilla'?

Question 2:

Which response appropriately answers: 'How are you?'

Question 3:

What pronoun always pairs with 'am'?

Check Your Understanding



Answer 1:

is

Answer 2:

I am fine, thank you.

Answer 3:

I